STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-5200
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **12/22/21**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES CALEA 31.4.1			
SUBJECT EMPLOYEE HIRING AND SEPARATION	CROSS REFERENCE G-3300 UNIFORMS G-5210 PRE-EMPLOYMENT BACKGROUND INVESTIGATION G-8400 TRAINING PROGRAM MERIT COMMISSION RULES			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for hiring and separation of Sheriff's Office employees.

II. Policy:

To ensure the proper processing of newly hired employees and those separating from employment, the Sheriff's Office shall adhere to established guidelines.

III. Procedures:

A. Hiring-Sworn Employees: The hiring of sworn employees shall be conducted in accordance with the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Merit Commission Rules in effect at the time of hiring.

1. When there is an opening, or multiple openings, for a sworn position within the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office, notification shall be submitted to the Merit Commission.

2. The Merit Commission will be responsible for providing the Sheriff's Office with a list of acceptable candidates, unless the commission causes the Sheriff's Office to administer the initial examination known as the "General Test".

3. All prospective deputies shall undergo and pass a pre-employment background investigation (see G-5210 Pre-employment Background Investigation) prior to the hiring interviewing.

4. After completing the pre-employment background investigation and Merit Commission certification, the top three (3) candidates shall be interviewed by the Sheriff or his designee. The Sheriff will select one (1) candidate from this group.

5. The new deputy shall meet with the Training Sergeant who shall complete the Employee Checklist. The following tasks shall be competed:

a) The new deputy shall be scheduled for physical and psychological examinations.
b) The NLETC application shall be completed, and enrollment shall be verified.
c) The new deputy shall meet with the Sheriff's Office Account Clerk and the County Personnel Department to compete appropriate forms.
d) The Training Sergeant shall create training and personnel files.
e) The Training Sergeant shall schedule a swearing in ceremony.
f) The Training Sergeant shall issue a Sheriff's Office identification card and badge, Standard Operating Procedures manual and equipment (see G-3300 Uniforms).
g) The Training Sergeant shall schedule the new deputy for the Sheriff's Office training program (see G-8400 Training Program).

B. **Hiring- Non-Sworn Employees:** The hiring of non-sworn employees will be conducted in accordance with the Sarpy County Personnel Rules and Regulations in effect at the time of hiring.

1. When an opening occurs for a non-sworn position within the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office, a "Personnel Requisition Form" will be submitted to the Human Resources Department.

2. The Human Resources Department will be responsible for providing the Sheriff's Office with a list of acceptable candidates. (See https://www.sarpy.gov/279/Personnel-Rules-Regulations).

3. All non-sworn employees shall undergo and pass a pre-employment background investigation (see G-5210 Pre-Employment Background Investigation) prior to the hiring interviewing.

4. The Sheriff's Office will interview the prospective candidates and grade the interview using objective criteria.

5. All candidates shall be notified of their status.

6. The successful candidate will undergo a polygraph examination and urinalysis test prior to hiring.

7. The new non-sworn employee shall meet with the Office Manager or Training Sergeant who shall assign a current employee to complete an Employee Orientation Form (non-sworn) for the new employee. The following tasks shall be competed:

a) The new employee shall meet with the Sheriff's Office Account Clerk and the County Personnel Department to complete appropriate forms.

b) The Office Manager shall coordinate with the Training Manager and/or Training Sergeant to schedule training.

c) Upon completion of training, the Office Manager shall assign the new employee to a specific position.

C. **Resignation:** The Administrative Commander or his or her designee shall be responsible for processing resigning employees. Employees wishing to resign should contact an Administrative Commander; if a resignation letter is received by any other employee, it shall be forwarded to an Administrative Commander. Employees who voluntarily resign prior to the age of fifty-five (55) shall also adhere to the following procedures.

1. If an employee wishes to resign prior to age fifty-five (55), he or she shall notify an administrative commander. An administrative commander shall provide and explain a Separation of Service packet. The administrative commander shall complete a Separation of Service Information form.

2. The administrative commander shall provide the employee with a Resignation Letter for his or her signature.

3. The administrative commander shall also provide the employee with an Exit Questionnaire to be returned to Sarpy County Personnel.

4. The administrative commander shall complete an Acceptance Letter and provide the Resignation Letter and the Acceptance Letter to the Sheriff. The administrative commander shall provide a signed copy of the Acceptance Letter to the employee.

5. The administrative commander shall notify, by memorandum, Payroll and the employee's chain of command regarding the employee's pending separation.

6. The administrative commander shall make arrangements for the return of any issued equipment (see G-3300 Uniforms).

7. At the pre-arranged time, the administrative commander or his or her designee shall meet with the employee and ensure all issued material and equipment are returned. Upon confirmation that all material and equipment has been returned the administrative commander shall notify, by memorandum, the command staff regarding the employee's separation. The administrative commander shall also notify Payroll to complete the separation process including the final pay-out.

8. The administrative commander or his or her designee shall ensure that all files and records, including the employee's training file, are placed in the employee's personnel file and the file shall be placed into the Past Employee file.

D. **Retirement:** A minimum of ten (10) years of continuous service and be at least fifty-five (55) years of age or older.

1. The employee shall notify an administrative commander. An administrative commander shall provide and explain a Separation of Service packet.

2. The employee may request to take up to eight (8) weeks of accrued vacation or compensatory time.

3. The employee shall receive payment for remaining accrued vacation, compensatory, and sick time according to the current FOP contract.

4. The administrative commander or his or her designee shall then complete the applicable procedures above (section C, 1 through 8) for a retirement.

E. **Termination:** At the time an employee is terminated by the Sheriff, he or she shall immediately meet with the Administrative Commander or his or her designee.

1. An Administrative Commander shall immediately take the employee's staff identification and key card.

2. An Administrative Commander shall notify the employee that he or she is not allowed in any Sheriff's Office facility without a designated escort. An Administrative Commander shall notify all employees, by memorandum, of the individual's separation and that he or she is not permitted in any Sheriff's Office facility without an escort.

3. An Administrative Commander shall explain and provide a Separation of Service Packet. The employee shall be provided a letter of termination signed by the Sheriff.

4. An Administrative Commander or his or her designee shall then complete the above procedures (section C, 6 through 8) for a resignation.

F. **Separation of Sworn-Employees:** Any final change of status or separation from employment, shall require the completion of a Personnel Change of Status form by the Training Sergeant. As required by law, this form shall be submitted to the Nebraska Law Enforcement Training Center.

G. **Exit Interview:** All employees who resign, retire or are terminated shall be requested to participate in an exit interview with the Sarpy County Personnel Office. The Administrative Commander or his or her designee shall be responsible for requesting and scheduling the exit interview as soon as possible after the employee's separation from the Sheriff's Office. The exit interview shall be utilized to determine potential improvements to the Sheriff's Office specifically the hiring and training processes.